

Microsoft Movie Studio:Data Driven Strategy for movie creation

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Data Driven Strategy for Movie creation

Group Members

1.Sylvia Wanyonyi- Sylvia.wanyonyi@moringaschool.com

2.Kelvin Obungu- Obungu-Kelvin.obungu@student.moringaschool.com

3.Samuel Okaro- Samuel.onyango2@student.moringaschool.com

4.Benedict Wambua- Benedict.wambua@student.moringaschool.com

Business Context

Microsoft is evaluating entry into the global film production industry.

- The objective is to identify movie genres that maximize audience satisfaction and long-term brand value.
- To develop a strategic genre approach to reduce risk and strengthens studio credibility.
- Optimize Release & Distribution Strategy by tailoring content and release timing to regional preferences.

This analysis uses historical data

Business Questions



Which movies earned the most revenue?(Domestic and foreign)



Which genres consistently delivered higher audience satisfaction?



What ratings and revenue trends should guide Microsoft in movie creation?



Which studios created the best rated movies?

Data Sources

Three linked datasets were used for this analysis



IMDb – Basics– Genre classification and production year



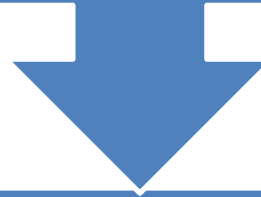
IMDb –Ratings-Average audience ratings and vote counts



Bom movies– Domestic and international gross revenue

Methodology overview

Datasets were cleaned and missing values handled



Datasets were merged using a unique movie identifier.(tconst)

Average ratings were calculated by genre and year.

Movies were grouped by genre and ratings to evaluate performance over time and audience reception.

Revenue and ratings were compared.

Trends were analyzed over time.

Key Finding 1 : Highest Revenue Movies



Sequel and cinematic movies dominate the highest revenue rankings, including Marvel, Star Wars, Harry Potter, and Disney properties.



Superhero and fantasy genres consistently generate the highest revenues, indicating strong global appeal.



Sequel movies outperform standalone films, benefiting from established fan bases and brand loyalty.

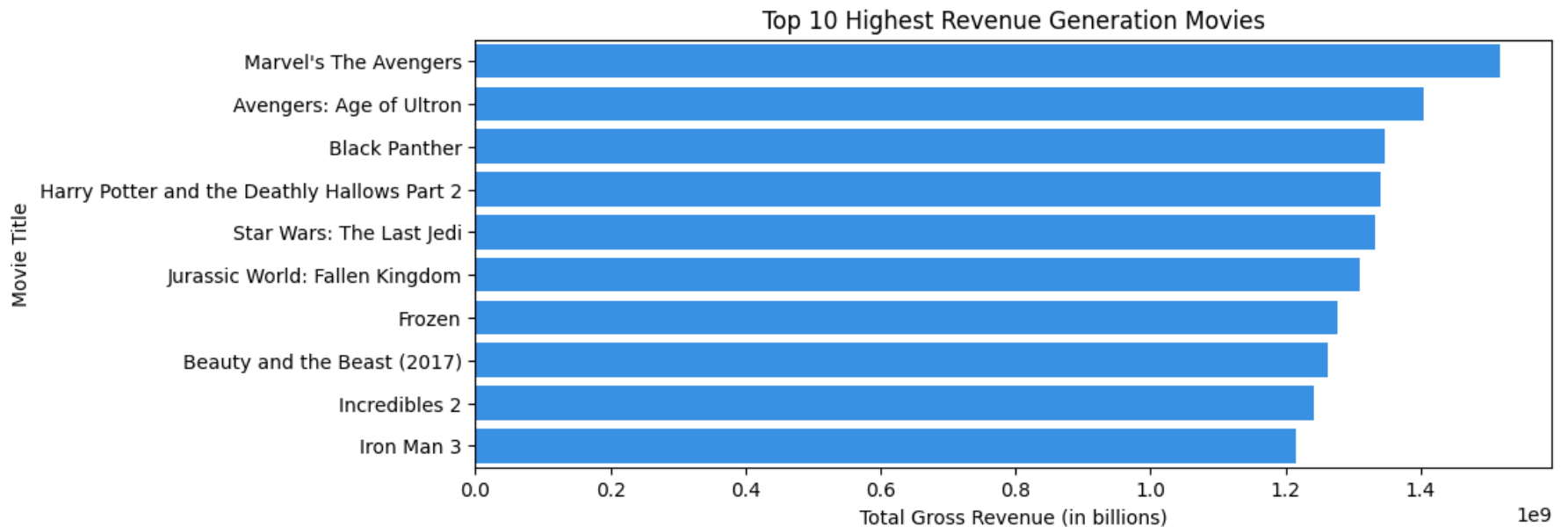


Family-friendly titles (e.g., Frozen, Beauty and the Beast) perform exceptionally well, showing broad demographic reach.



The revenue gap between top-performing films and average releases is significant, highlighting a “blockbuster-driven” revenue model.

Top 10 Highest Revenue Generation movies



Key Finding 2: Ratings By Genres



Movies with higher audience engagement tend to receive higher ratings.

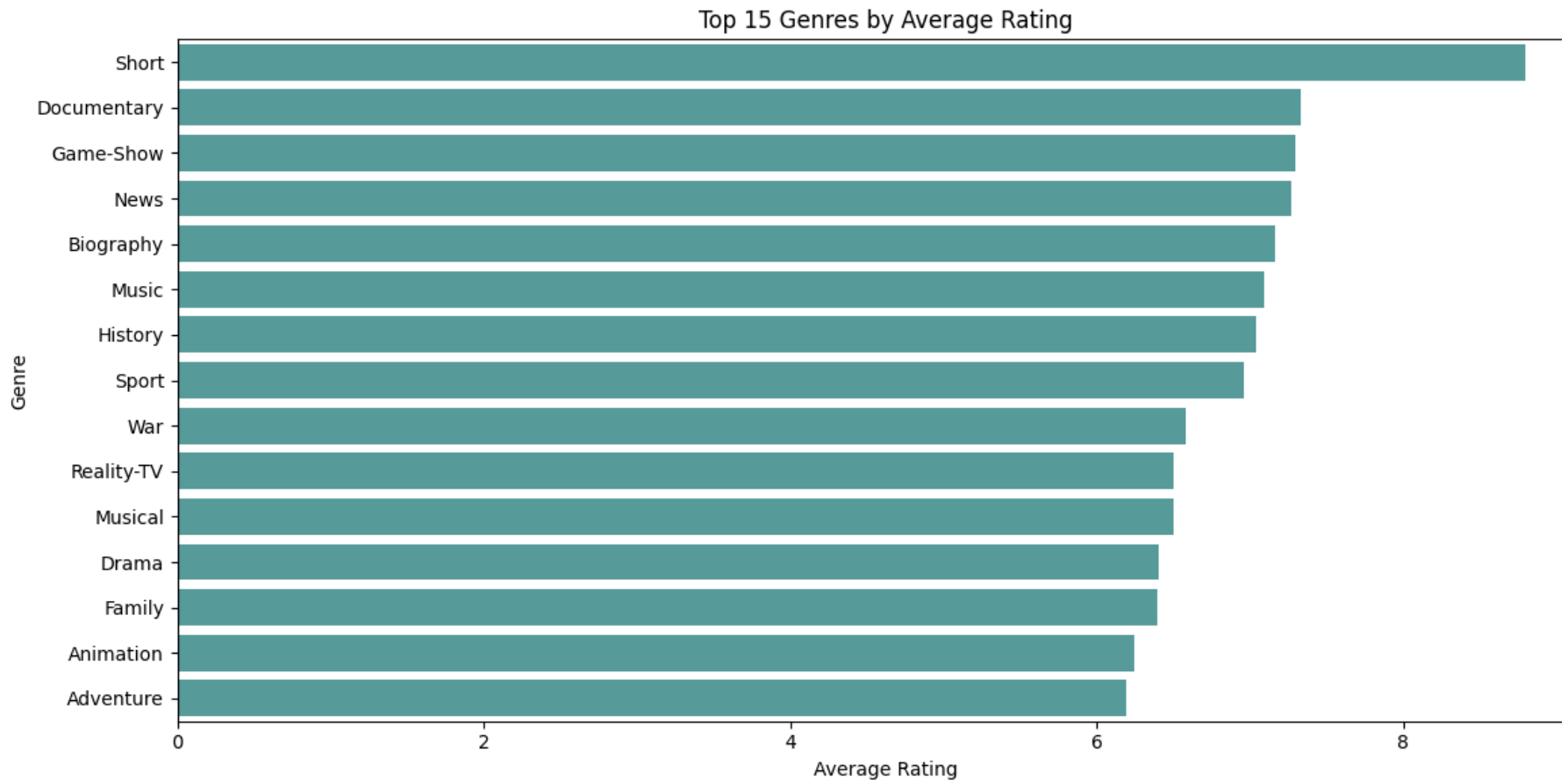


Popular, well-rated movies perform better commercially



Genres with comparatively low average audience ratings may reflect over saturation or weaker storylines

Movie Rating by Genres



Key Finding 3: Trends Over Time



Documentary, biography, and history genres show a steady upward trend, indicating growing audience appreciation over time

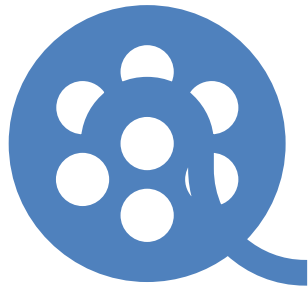


Action and adventure maintain stable ratings, suggesting consistent audience demand and predictable performance.



Drama and family genres show moderate improvement, reflecting steady but less aggressive growth.

Trends Over Time- Finding

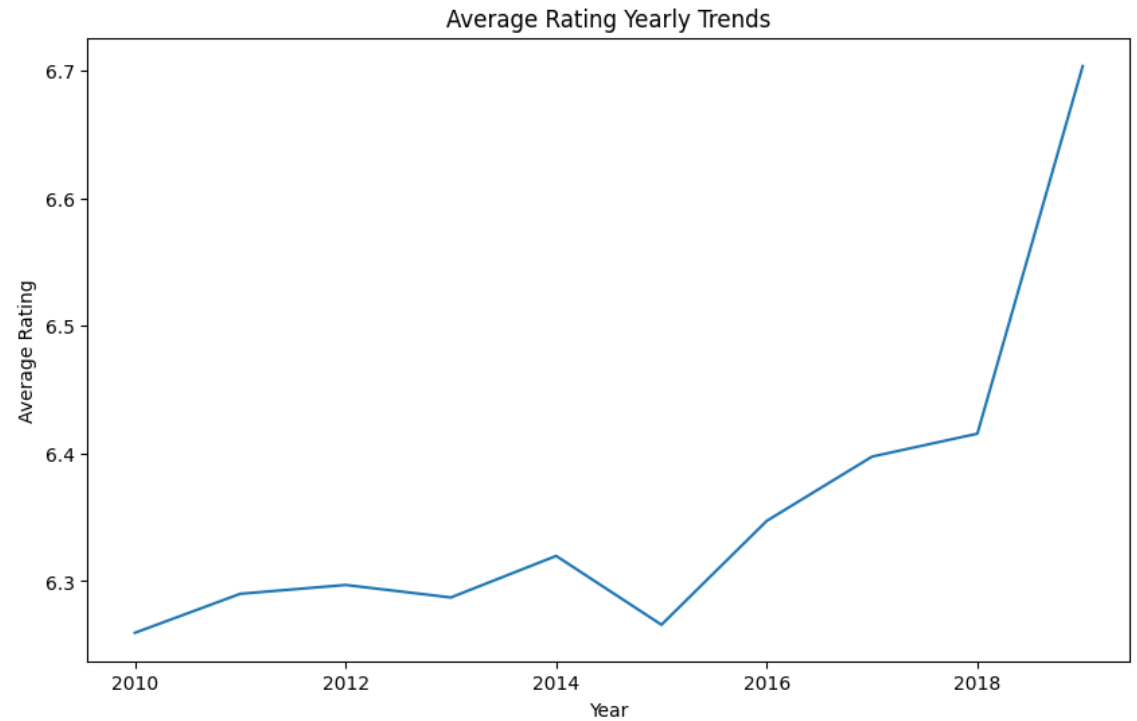


Some genres (e.g., horror and certain niche genres) start from lower ratings but improve toward later years, signaling potential emerging opportunities.



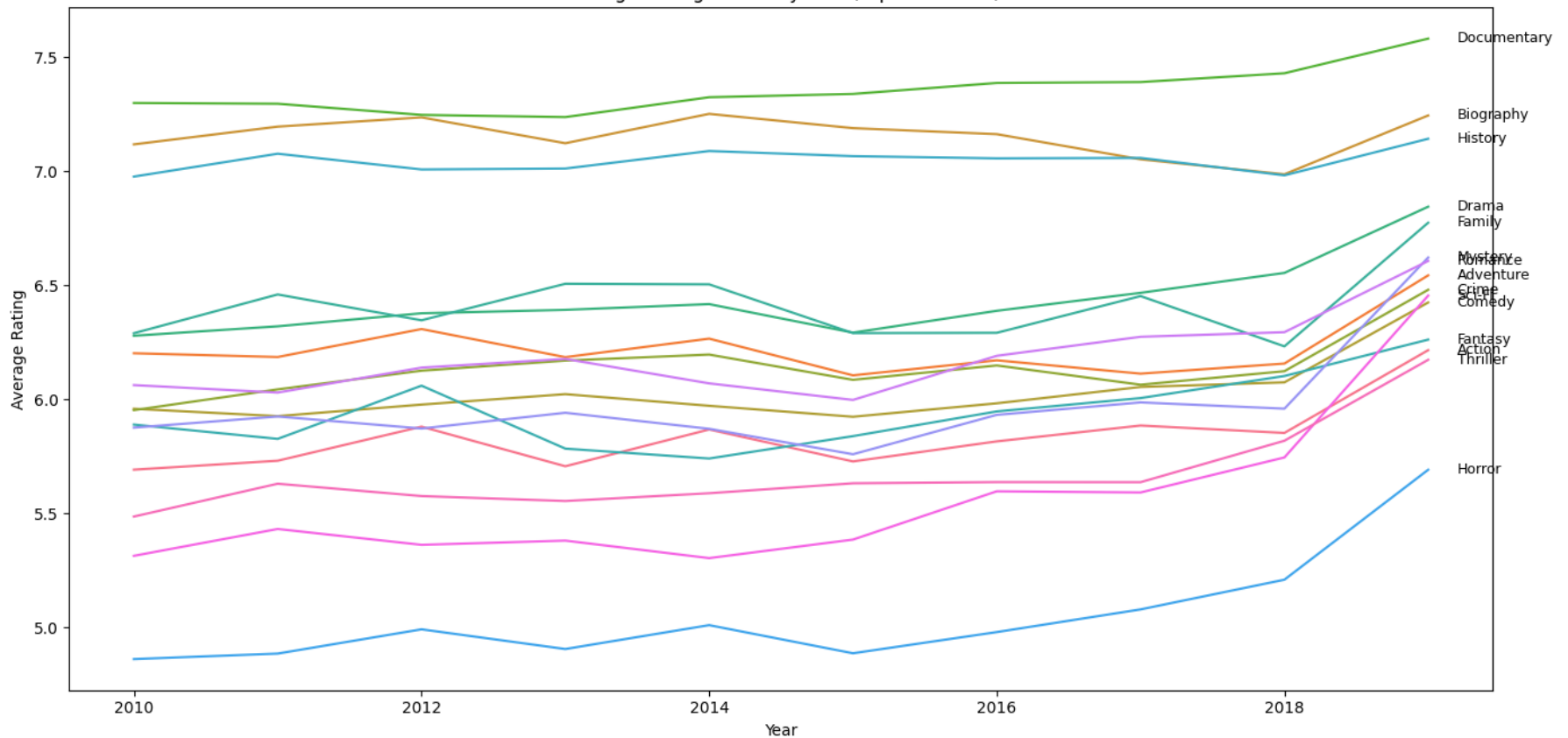
Genres with declining or flat trends may require re-positioning, refreshed storytelling, or lower investment priority.

Average rating over time



Average rating trends by Genres

Average Rating Trends by Year (Top 15 Genres)

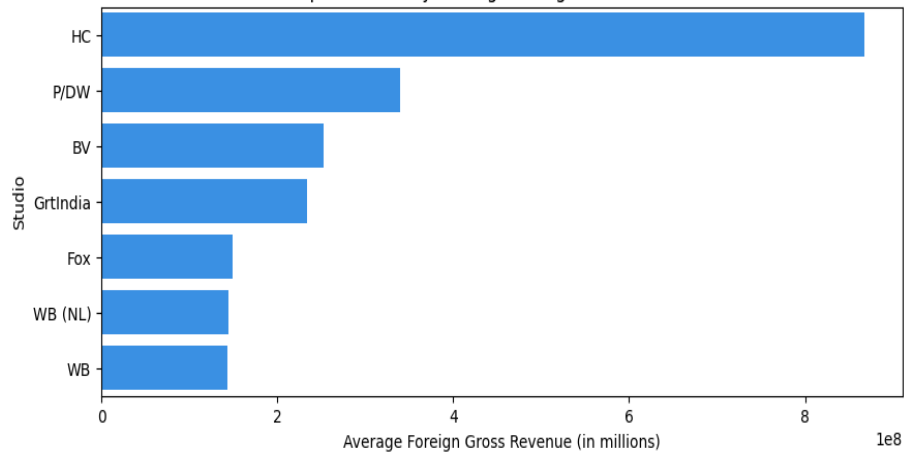


Finding 4: Studio performance

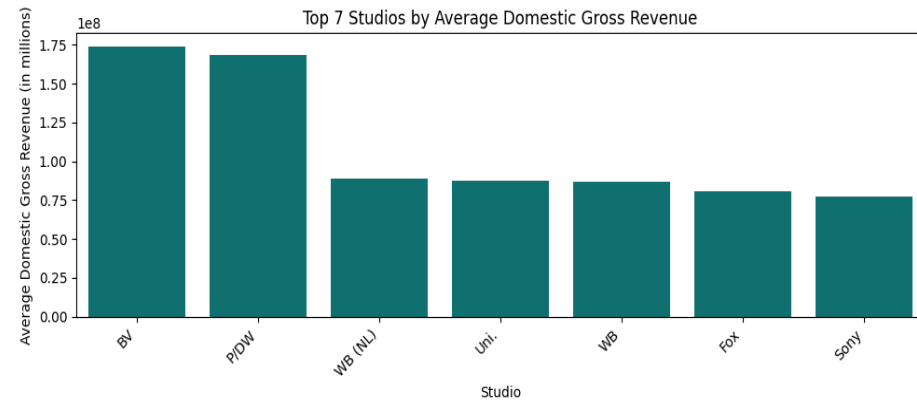
- **P/DW and BV consistently rank among the top studios in both domestic and foreign box office revenue**, indicating strong global market appeal. While **WB** performs strongly in the domestic market and **HC** leads internationally, the cross-market success .

Foreign and Domestic gross revenue by Studio

Top 7 Studios by Average Foreign Gross Revenue



Top 7 Studios by Average Domestic Gross Revenue



Reccomendation: Genres



Prioritize revenue-driving genres for launch: Focus on Action, Adventure, and Sci-Fi, as these genres consistently lead global box office revenue and show strong international appeal.



Invest in high-rated genres to build reputation: Allocate resources to Short, Documentary, Game Show, News, and Biography to drive critical acclaim, audience satisfaction, and brand credibility.



Reevaluate underperforming genres: Conduct deeper analysis of Adventure, Animation, and Family to understand gaps in storytelling, marketing, or audience fit before scaling investment.



Adopt a balanced portfolio strategy: Maintain selective presence in popular commercial genres for box office or streaming traction, while prioritizing high-rated content to establish a strong studio identity

Reccommendation: Studios

01

Leverage top domestic performers (BV, P/DW, WB):
Drive stable home-market revenue through sequels, franchises, and targeted domestic marketing.

02

Capitalize on strong foreign performers (HC, P/DW, BV):
Expand international distribution, partnerships, and market-specific content strategies.

03

Align domestic and global strategies:
Prioritize studios with strong performance in both markets (P/DW, BV) to reduce risk and maximize cross-market revenue.

04

Prioritize P/DW projects:
Allocate greater resources to P/DW, leveraging its consistent domestic and international success to maximize total gross revenue and mitigate market volatility

Recommendation: Ratings



Invest in high-visibility projects:

Prioritize films likely to attract large audiences, as higher engagement correlates with better ratings.



Encourage audience participation:

Promote campaigns or platforms that drive votes and reviews to boost perceived movie quality.



Analyze 2018 spike drivers:

Investigate factors behind the sudden rise in 2018—genre, marketing, cast, or release strategy—and replicate successful elements in future releases.

Recommendation:Revenue

Strengthen Domestic Revenue as a Safety Net

- Leverage streaming and digital releases to expand domestic reach.
- Implement targeted marketing campaigns to key domestic audiences.
- Partner with other movie stakeholders to maximize home-market revenue.

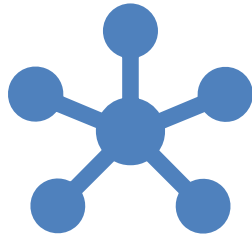
Leverage Predictive Analysis for Foreign Revenue

- Use data-driven forecasts to anticipate international market trends.
- Develop a risk management plan based on projected foreign performance.

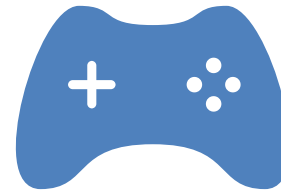
Optimize Release & Distribution Strategy

- Tailor content, marketing, and release timing to regional preferences.
- Align distribution channels and promotional efforts with target markets to maximize impact

General Recommendation



Leverage Microsoft's Ecosystem



By integrating film content with Xbox, Game Pass, Azure, AI, and streaming platforms to maximize cross-platform monetization and audience reach.

Conclusion

To position Microsoft's new movie studio for success, a **data-driven, balanced approach** is recommended.

Strengthening domestic revenue through streaming, targeted marketing, and strategic partnerships provides a stable base, while predictive analysis of foreign markets enables proactive risk management. Content strategy should focus on high-performing and high-rated genres—Action, Adventure, Sci-Fi, Short, Documentary, Game Show, News, and Biography—while carefully analyzing underperforming genres before committing significant resources.

Optimized release and distribution strategies tailored to regional preferences, combined with initiatives to boost audience engagement and voting, will maximize ratings, viewership, and cross-market revenue. Leveraging top-performing studios such as P/DW and BV ensures strong domestic and international appeal, supporting sustainable growth, reputation-building, and long-term success for the new studio.